initiated procurement conversations and the NEGVAC looked closely at the larger issues related to vaccine procurement, administration, import, export, priority groups and so on, the Empowered Group 1 dealt with day-to-day nitty-gritties of the vaccination drive. For instance, it would look at the status of the stock availability, accountability of manufacturers and amount of doses to import and export. Basically, VTF, NEGVAC and Empowered Group 1 operated simultaneously, overseeing interrelated arrangements to cover all issues related to India's vaccination journey.

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All through the second wave while the government struggled with optimizing resources, the high courts and the Supreme Court stayed heavily involved, forcing the central government as well as the state governments to allocate time from already stretched officers towards hearings. The fact that the courts became so involved in the government's pandemic management certainly warrants a discussion on the role of the judiciary as originally envisioned by the Indian Constitution. Many former Supreme Court justices have expressed opinions on the limitations and responsibilities of the Indian judiciary. Former Supreme Court Judge K.S. Radhakrishnan, in his comments to a media house during the COVID-19 hearing in Supreme Court, had explicitly noted, 'Administration is the job of the elected government. The Supreme Court cannot deal with highly sensitive and technical issues as it does not have the machinery for it.'[57] Considering that he spoke from experience, if the Supreme Court Bench led by Chief Justice S.A. Bobde including justices S. Ravindra Bhat and L. Nageswara Rao did not have the technical experience, was asking the Centre to submit a national COVID-19 management plan for review justified?[58] Or would that be considered judicial overreach into the executive and legislative branches of the Indian government? Now that we have the luxury to look back at past events in retrospect, let us take another example: during the hearing on the oxygen supply to Delhi, the Supreme Court ordered the Centre to provide 700 MT of oxygen on a daily basis. What became clear after the top Court ordered an oxygen audit on the Centre's insistence was that Delhi did not need that much oxygen. This episode let many journalists to conclude,

> Courts might have created more problems than they solved. Their decisions on fixing the quota that Chief Minister Kejriwal